07 GARDEN TUNNEL
THE ARCHED TRELLIS

Set the last stake, then plan the run the rest of the way.

LEVEL	CREW	WHERE	STAGE NOW
■□□ Open to all	1–3	Garden (route to be walked with Yusuf)	Final stake + run plan

A tunnel of arches for climbing plants: shade in summer, fruit overhead. This guide assumes arches made of livestock (cattle) panels, 16 ft × 50 in, bent between two rows of posts about 6 ft apart, giving an arch roughly 6½–7 ft high. If your arches are a different material, the run-planning steps still hold.

FIRST STEPS *today*

1. Run a string line from the first post through the existing posts so the final stake lines up.
2. Measure the spacing between existing posts and match it. Drive the final stake plumb (check with a level on two sides).
3. Fit and wire the last panel at three points per side.
4. Walk the rest of the route with Yusuf. String a centerline and flag every future post location.
5. Count materials: per arch, 1 panel, 4 T-posts, about 12 wire ties.

BEFORE YOU START

- Panel ends are sharp. Wear gloves and eye protection when bending and cutting.
- Bending a panel takes two people: one holds each end while you walk them toward each other.
- Post drivers are heavy. Keep hands below the top of the driver and wear ear protection.

THE BASICS

Posts	Steel T-posts driven 18–24 in deep, two per side of each arch. The panel ends sit inside the posts and are wired at three points.
Spacing	Arches touching make a full green tunnel. Gaps of 1–4 ft make a rhythm of light and shade.
Path	At least 4 ft wide to walk through with a wheelbarrow.
Plants	Passion fruit (already growing at Hira, vigorous and evergreen in LA). Grapes, the classic Afghan and Persian arbor. Beans, cucumbers and gourds for seasonal cover. Jasmine or climbing rose for scent.

THE PLAN *in order*

01	**Finish the current arch**	Final stake, panel fitted and wired.
02	**Plan the run**	Centerline, slope check, where the tunnel ends (a gate, a bench, the fig?), gap spacing.
03	**Materials**	Panels, posts, ties ordered.
04	**Install**	Posts driven, panels bent and wired, one arch at a time.
05	**Water**	Drip line along both sides on a timer.

06	**Plant**	Perennials this fall; seasonal climbers in spring.

TOOLS & MATERIALS

Cattle panels · T-posts + post driver · Bolt cutters · Wire or heavy zip ties · String line, stakes, flags · Tape measure, level · Gloves, glasses, ear protection

FOR YUSUF TO DECIDE

- ? Route and end point
- ? Touching or spaced arches
- ? Plant list
- ? Drip irrigation layout